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The Chief Executive Officer
Makoni Rural District Council
Stand No. 396 Stockton Street
P.O. Box 255
Rusape

RE: APPLICATION FOR THE GIS GRADUATE TRAINEE POSITION

Dear Chief Executive Officer,

I am writing to express my interest in the GIS Graduate Trainee position at Makoni Rural District Council. As a recent graduate from Stellenbosch University with a Bachelor of Arts in Development and Environment, majoring in Geography and Public and Development Management, I am eager to begin my career in Geographic Information Systems within local government. My academic background, combined with my recent experience on the Marondera Municipality Property Survey conducted by ZimStat, has strengthened both my technical skills and my interest in using GIS to support effective planning and service delivery.

Throughout my Geography studies, I developed a strong foundation in Geographic Information Systems, spatial analysis, and environmental mapping. Using QGIS, I worked with spatial datasets to analyse geographic patterns, produce maps, and interpret environmental information for a range of academic projects. These experiences taught me the importance of accurate spatial data and how GIS can be used to support evidence-based planning and decision-making.

Earlier this year, I worked as an Enumerator on the Marondera Municipality Property Survey. While my primary responsibility was collecting accurate property information, the role also introduced me to the practical application of GIS within a municipal environment. I used digital maps to identify Enumeration Areas, navigate assigned wards, and record geographically referenced property information while ensuring that all data met strict quality standards. The experience highlighted the importance of accurate spatial information in maintaining reliable municipal records and reinforced my interest in pursuing a career in GIS.

I am particularly drawn to this opportunity because it offers practical experience in many of the areas I hope to develop further, including geospatial data processing, digitising, geo-referencing, GIS database management, map production, and spatial data quality assurance. I am confident using QGIS and am eager to expand my skills by learning ESRI ArcGIS and other GIS technologies used by the Council. I enjoy learning new software, pay close attention to detail, and take pride in producing accurate and well-organised work.

In addition to my technical skills, I have developed strong communication, organisational, and teamwork abilities through my experience as a university tutor and departmental assistant at

Stellenbosch University. These roles strengthened my ability to work collaboratively, manage multiple responsibilities, and communicate technical information clearly to different audiences. I believe these qualities, together with my analytical mindset and willingness to learn, would enable me to contribute positively to your GIS team.

I am excited by the opportunity to begin my professional career with Makoni Rural District Council and to contribute to the management and development of spatial information that supports land administration, infrastructure planning, and service delivery. As a motivated and dedicated graduate, I would welcome the opportunity to learn from experienced professionals while making a meaningful contribution to the Council.

Thank you for considering my application. I would be grateful for the opportunity to discuss how my academic background, practical GIS experience, and enthusiasm for spatial technologies would make me a valuable addition to your team.

Yours faithfully,

Rufaro Songore